

How to Participate

Phase 0 is the right moment to ask questions, raise concerns, and help shape what comes next.

Village Residents & Landowners

Your land, local knowledge and voice shape the design. Join the community consultation.

Forestry & Energy Professionals

Feasibility input, technical review, and partnership in implementation.

Investors & Philanthropists

Phase 0 funding for feasibility studies, legal structure, and early outreach.

Researchers & Academics

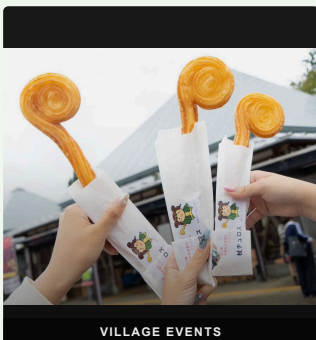
Collaborate on open data, carbon measurement, and rural energy modelling.

Other Rural Communities

Everything built here is documented and shared openly — free for any village to replicate.



JINJA FESTIVAL



VILLAGE EVENTS

Mitsue.

ECOLOGY · ENERGY · DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE



mitsue.it

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Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture, Japan
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THE MITSUE PROJECT

Ecology · Energy
Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan

MIT Sue VILLAGE · NARA · JAPAN

THE PROJECT

Three Pillars

Forest Restoration

Aging cedar monoculture replaced with native mixed forest, healing land depleted for decades. Landowners receive timber income from Year 2.

Biomass CHP & Energy Resilience

Sugi forest thinnings fuel a biomass CHP system — electricity for the village (primary), heat (secondary). Solar panels and EV charging complement this locally owned system, with blackout resilience built in.

Sustainable AI Data Center

A small, efficient digital facility inside the Mitsue Taiken Koryukan, powered entirely by local renewable energy — creating employment and stable revenue where none existed. Phase 2 expands to an old factory in Mitsue.

"These are not three separate ideas — each one makes the others possible."



CEDAR FOREST



EV CHARGING



COMMUNITY

PHASE 0 · NOW OPEN

What We're Building

The Mitsue Taiken Koryukan and its surrounding cedar forest — transformed into a living model of rural self-sufficiency.

WHY HERE?

- ✓ Taiken Koryukan available for reuse
- ✓ Productive cedar forest within reach
- ✓ Resident engineer with deep local roots
- ✓ Village leadership open to new ideas

FUNDED BY

林野庁 forest grants · METI/NEDO biomass & rural energy grants · FIT/FIP feed-in tariff · J-Credit carbon income · Data center service revenue · Impact investment & philanthropy

ADVISORS

- Joi Ito — Former Director, MIT Media Lab
- Ray Ozzie — Former Chief Software Architect, Microsoft
- Takuo Dome — Founder, Social Solution Initiative, Osaka University
- San Poisson — Project Manager

MILESTONES

Timeline

Benefits arrive well before Year 25 — the 25-year horizon describes full forest restoration, not how long the village waits.

- Year 1 Taiken Koryukan opens as community & innovation hub; international media visibility for Mitsue
- Year 2 Landowners begin receiving income from cedar harvest
- Year 3–4 Biomass CHP unit & EV charging operational; battery storage for blackout resilience
- Year 4–5 Data center operational; local jobs in operations & maintenance
- Year 5–10 Revenue reinvested into village and forest programmes
- Year 25 Native forest established; model documented and shared openly

About the Team

Rob Oudendijk — Dutch electrical engineer, resident of Mitsue since 2012. Core hardware developer for *Safecast*, the open citizen science network born after Fukushima, with over 250 million published measurements.

A dedicated non-profit is being established with local residents, village leadership, forestry professionals, and academic partners.

